

Dear Thumbtack Growth Engineering team,

Reading your overview of the CAGE team, I was struck by the parallels between what you need and my experience, both professional and personal. When I take on a project of either kind, I look for the balance between trying new things and keeping an eye on the fundamentals.

I have been a homeowner for many years and am currently building a custom multi-level deck with several ambitious features – a spiral staircase, bent deck boards, a large water feature. Before any of that began, though, I had a solid design done by a licensed architect, researched options with experienced professionals, and decided which portions I needed assistance on and which I could tackle myself – which is, as I understand it, exactly the decision Thumbtack exists to help homeowners make.

My professional career spans the same range: from large organizations with established, rigorous processes to one-on-one work with individual entrepreneurs, turning their ideas and expertise into iOS applications that serve both them and their customers. At Walmart, as the Principal engineer responsible for the iOS checkout platform, experimentation was a core part of our process: every new or modified feature was gated by a feature flag, and more than half were part of A/B tests. Feature leads – I personally led several each year – were responsible for building in the appropriate analytics and telemetry, creating or updating dashboards for team-wide visibility, and tracking performance and usage while the feature was under test.

For smaller clients, I develop a plan and proof of concept from their initial idea, then iterate on that base – offering options and suggesting alternatives as we flesh out the application together.

With the growing usefulness of LLMs and related tools, it is possible to experiment and validate ideas faster than ever. I have made heavy use of Claude Code and Codex this year, both on a solo client build (an incident-management app for volunteer fire departments) and inside a larger, established company (CLEAR).

I believe I would be a strong addition to the CAGE team, and I would welcome a conversation about your particular needs.

Thank you for your consideration,
Doug Sjoquist